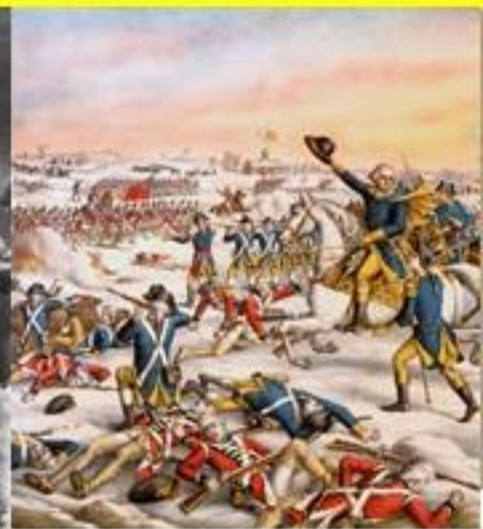


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE – 26

FIRST WORLD WAR - 1

CHANGES THAT TOOK PLACE IN EUROPE PRIOR TO WORLD WAR-I

1 COLONIALISM

- 1 Colonialism is the extension of a nation's sovereignty over another territory beyond its borders.
- 2 Colonizers generally dominate the resources, labour, and markets of the colonial territory.
- 3 They also impose socio-cultural, religious and linguistic aspects on the conquered population.
- 4 European colonialism began in the 15th century with the "Age of Discovery". This was led by Portuguese and Spanish explorations of the Americas, and the coasts of Africa, the Middle East, India, and East Asia.
- 5 By 17th century, England, France and Holland successfully established their own overseas empires, in direct competition with each other and those of Spain and Portugal.



CHANGES THAT TOOK PLACE IN EUROPE PRIOR TO WORLD WAR-I

1 COLONIALISM

6 Spain and Portugal were weakened after the loss of their New World colonies.

7 But Britain, France and Holland turned their attention to the Old World, particularly South Africa, India and South East Asia, where colonies were established.

8 The industrialization of the 19th century led to what has been termed the era of New Imperialism.

9 The fight among the European countries to control and establish new colonies led to the First World War.



CHANGES THAT TOOK PLACE IN EUROPE PRIOR TO WORLD WAR- I

1 COLONIALISM

10 There are different types of colonies.

SETTLER COLONIES

- **Settler colonies**, such as the original thirteen states of the United States of America, Canada, Australia, New Zealand and Argentina arose from the **emigration of peoples from a mother country**.
- This led to the **displacement of the indigenous peoples**.

COLONIES OF DEPENDENCIES

- **Colonies of dependencies** came into existence due to the **conquest by foreign countries**.
- Examples in this category include the **British India, Dutch Indonesia, French Indo-China, and the Japanese colonial empire**.

PLANTATION COLONIES

- **Plantation colonies** such as Barbados, Saint-Dominguez and Jamaica, where the **white colonizers imported black slaves** – who **rapidly began to outnumber their owners** – led to **minority rule, similar to a dependency**.



CHANGES THAT TOOK PLACE IN EUROPE PRIOR TO WORLD WAR-I

2 IMPERIALISM

- 1 Imperialism is a policy of extending control or authority over colonized countries. The term is used to describe the policy of a nation's dominance over distant lands.
- 2 The "Age of Imperialism" usually refers to the Old Imperialism period starting from 1860, when major European states started colonizing the other continents.
- 3 The term 'Imperialism' was initially coined in the mid 1500's to reflect the policies of countries such as Britain and France who expanded into Africa, and the Americas.
- 4 Imperialism refers to the highest stage of capitalism which made it necessary to find new markets and resources.
- 5 This theory of necessary expansion of capitalism outside the boundaries of nation-states was shared by Lenin and Rosa Luxemburg.



CHANGES THAT TOOK PLACE IN EUROPE PRIOR TO WORLD WAR-I

3 ECONOMIC MARKET

- 1 Industrial Revolution created the need among the European countries to find new markets for their industrial goods.
- 2 Similarly, they had to find raw materials for their industries.
- 3 This dual need pushed the European countries to compete with each other to establish their political control over Asia, Africa and Latin America.



CHANGES THAT TOOK PLACE IN EUROPE PRIOR TO WORLD WAR- I

4 IMPROVEMENT IN COMMUNICATIONS

- 1 Advancement in science and technology led to improvement in transport and communication.
- 2 Steamships, Railroads, roadways were improved.
- 3 This helped imperialism to have a firm hold over the conquered territories.



CHANGES THAT TOOK PLACE IN EUROPE PRIOR TO WORLD WAR- I

5 RISE OF EXTREME NATIONALISM

- 1 The late 19th century was a period of intense nationalism.
- 2 Many nations developed myths of superiority over other peoples.
- 3 Each country wanted to have colonies to add to its prestige and power.
- 4 Writers and speakers in England, France and Germany opened institutions to promote the idea of imperialism.
- 5 European countries took great pride in calling their territories as empires.



CHANGES THAT TOOK PLACE IN EUROPE PRIOR TO WORLD WAR-I

6

THE CIVILIZING MISSION

- 1 In the minds of many Europeans, imperialist expansion was very noble.
- 2 They considered it a way of bringing civilization to the backward peoples of the world.
- 3 Explorers and adventurers, as well as missionaries helped in spreading imperialism.



THE VARIOUS CAUSES THAT LED TO FIRST WORLD WAR (1914 -1919)

1 SYSTEM OF ALLIANCES

- 1 The most important cause was the system of secret alliances.
- 2 Before 1914 Europe was divided into two camps.
- 3 It was Germany which created the division in European politics before World War I.
- 4 **Three Emperors League:**
 - In order to isolate France, Germany entered in to an alliance with Austria.
 - Bismarck formed the three Emperors League by making alliance with Russia.

- 5 **Triple Alliance:**
 - Later Germany did not care for Russia. Hence Russia left. But Germany continued its alliance with Austria alone. This was known as Dual alliance.
 - After Italy joined in this alliance, it became a Triple alliance.



THE VARIOUS CAUSES THAT LED TO FIRST WORLD WAR (1914 -1919)

1 SYSTEM OF ALLIANCES

6 Franco-Russian Alliance:

- In the meantime, Russia began to lean towards France.
- In 1894 there came Franco-Russian alliance against Austro-German alliance.

7 Triple Entente:

- It was at this time England followed a policy of splendid isolation. She also felt that she was all alone. First she wanted to join with Germany.
- When this became a failure, she entered into an alliance with Japan in 1902.
- In 1904 she made alliance with France. In 1907 Russia joined this alliance.
- This had resulted in Triple Entente.

8 Thus Europe was divided into two camps.

9 The secret nature of these alliances brought about the war of 1914.



THE VARIOUS CAUSES THAT LED TO FIRST WORLD WAR (1914 -1919)

2 MILITARISM

- 1 The countries in Europe had been increasing their armies and navies.
- 2 This was the main reason for universal fear, hatred and suspicions among the countries of Europe.
- 3 In Europe, England and Germany were superior in Navy.
- 4 There were competitions between these two countries in naval armaments.
- 5 For every ship built by Germany, two ships were built by England.



THE VARIOUS CAUSES THAT LED TO FIRST WORLD WAR (1914 -1919)

3 NARROW NATIONALISM

- 1 It was also a cause for the war. The love of the country demanded the hatred of another.
- 2 For instance, love of Germany demanded the hatred of France. Likewise, the French people hated the German people.
- 3 In Eastern Europe narrow nationalism played a greater role. The Serbians hated Austria-Hungary.
- 4 **Alsace-Lorraine:**
 - The desire for the people of France to get back Alsace-Lorraine was also a cause for the outbreak of First World War.
 - It was Bismarck who had taken away Alsace-Lorraine from France and annexed them with Germany in 1871.
 - The result was that there grew animosities between these two countries.
 - It was this reason that forced Germany to take steps to isolate France by making alliances with other countries.



THE VARIOUS CAUSES THAT LED TO FIRST WORLD WAR (1914 -1919)

4 WILLIAM II

- 1 The Emperor of Germany himself was a cause for the First World War.
- 2 He wanted to make Germany a stronger power.
- 3 He was not prepared to make any compromise in international affairs.
- 4 He was mistaken in assessing Great Britain's strength.
- 5 It was a misunderstanding of the British character by William II that was responsible for the war.



THE VARIOUS CAUSES THAT LED TO FIRST WORLD WAR (1914 -1919)

5 PRUSSIAN SPIRIT

- 1** This spirit by Germany was also a cause for war.
- 2** The Prussians were taught that war was legal in the world.
- 3** War was the national industry of Prussia.
- 4** The younger generation of Germany was indoctrinated with such a philosophy of war.



THE VARIOUS CAUSES THAT LED TO FIRST WORLD WAR (1914 -1919)

6 PUBLIC OPINION

- 1 The position of public opinion by the newspapers was also a cause.
- 2 Often, the newspapers tried to inflame nationalist feeling by misrepresenting the situations in other countries.
- 3 Ambassadors and cabinet ministers admitted the senseless attitude of the leading newspapers in their own countries.



THE VARIOUS CAUSES THAT LED TO FIRST WORLD WAR (1914 -1919)

7 TRENTINO

1 The desire of Italy to recover the Trentino and the area around the port of Trieste was also a cause for war.

2 The Italians considered that these areas were inhabited by Italians.

3 But they were still part and parcel of Austria-Hungary.

4 They cried for the redemption of these territories.

5 Italy also entered into a competition with Austria to control the Adriatic Sea.

6 As Austria was not prepared to put up with the competition, there arose bitterness in the relations of these two countries.



THE VARIOUS CAUSES THAT LED TO FIRST WORLD WAR (1914 -1919)

8 THE EASTERN QUESTION

- 1 It was also a factor for the war. This complicated the situation in the Balkans.
- 2 The misrule of Turkey resulted in discontentment.
- 3 There was a rivalry between Greece, Serbia and Bulgaria for the control of Macedonia which had a mixed population.



THE VARIOUS CAUSES THAT LED TO FIRST WORLD WAR (1914 -1919)

8 THE EASTERN QUESTION

BOSNIA AND HERZEGOVINA

- 1 On the occasion of Bosnian crises Russia supported Serbia.
- 2 Pan Slavism also created complications.
- 3 The questions Bosnia - Herzegovina in the Balkans was also similar to the problem of Alsace-Lorraine.
- 4 Bosnia and Herzegovina were given to Austria-Hungary by the Congress of Berlin in 1878.
- 5 This was strongly opposed by Serbia.



THE VARIOUS CAUSES THAT LED TO FIRST WORLD WAR (1914 -1919)

8 THE EASTERN QUESTION

BOSNIA AND HERZEGOVINA

- 6** A strong agitation was started in Serbia to separate these provinces from Austria-Hungary and unite them with Serbia.
- 7** This created rivalry between Serbia and Austria-Hungary. This became very keen after 1909.
- 8** Serbia also received moral support from her big brother Russia (The Serbs and Russians belong to Slav Race).



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To Contact us:

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0866 244 44 72

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